```
WebApplicationBuilder builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);
WebApplication app = builder.Build();

app.UseStaticFiles();     ❶

app.Run();
```

❶ Adds the StaticFileMiddleware to the pipeline

TIP Remember that you can view the application code for this book in the GitHub repository at http://mng.bz/Y1qN.

When the application receives a request, the ASP.NET Core web server handles it and passes it to the middleware pipeline. `StaticFileMiddleware` receives the request and determines whether it can handle it. If the requested file exists, the middleware handles the request and returns the file as the response, as shown in figure 4.9.